

OVERFLOW

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

INTRO: Throughout the entirety of God's Word we see the relationship between oil and the Holy Spirit. This truth is so plain that even non-Pentecostal theologians draw a parallel between the two.

Consider the importance of oil in Old Testament worship:

- Oil was used to fuel the light...
- Oil was used to anoint individuals...
- Oil was used in the bread and the wafers...

One of the most important uses for oil in Old Testament worship was to keep the lamp burning in the place of worship. Notice

Leviticus 24:2 (NKJV) *“Command the children of Israel that they bring to you pure oil of pressed olives for the light, to make the lamps burn continually.”* This scripture tells us that the lamp was to burn continually. The lamp was to be serviced in the mornings and in the evenings. Where there is no oil, there is no light.

The priest was responsible for making sure there was oil for the lamps in the Holy place.

Numbers 4:16 (NKJV) *“The appointed duty of Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest is the oil for the light, the sweet incense, the daily grain offering, the anointing oil, the oversight of all the tabernacle, of all that is in it, with the sanctuary and its furnishings.”*

One of the priestly responsibilities was to insure the lamps in the holy place never went out. In

order to do this the reservoir of oil had to remain full. No reservoir stays full on its own!

We are the priest of our own lives and the responsibility for remaining full belongs to us. Being filled is important, but continuing to be full is equally important!

Things that need to be refilled:

- A drink...
- A vehicle...
- A baby's bottle...
- A swimming pool...

We must decide whether we are going to run on empty (Susan running the vehicles out of gas) or function in the overflow. (Me overflowing the tank)

I. NO OVERFLOW - NO MINISTRY

Eli was a Judge and High Priest in Israel. Everything we know about Eli's personal life points to the fact that he was a godly man. However, there are three alarming facts about Eli that I want to point out:

- Eli lost his vision... Notice [1 Samuel 3:2](#) (NKJV) ***"It came to pass at that time, when Eli was laid down in his place, and his eyes began to wax dim, that he could not see."*** I am not as sure he couldn't see, as I am, he didn't want to see. ***"Where there is no vision the people perish."***
- Eli failed to maintain godliness in his home as well as at the church...
- Eli allowed the oil to run dry. The most disturbing thing about Eli to me is pointed out in [1 Samuel 3:3](#) (NKJV) ***"And ere the lamp of God went out in the temple of the LORD, where the ark of God was."***

Eli didn't do his job. He allowed the lamps to run empty rather than making sure there was an overflow of oil. It was literally impossible for the lamp to be refilled on it's own. Someone had to take care of it every morning and every evening. The oil in our personal lives and places of worship is not going to be placed on automatic refill we must take personal responsibility for the maintenance of the oil reservoir.

Judgment came to the house of Eli and also to Israel because someone neglected attempted to let the lamp to run empty. In one horrific day, Eli, his two sons, and his daughter-in-law died! Before his daughter-in-law died, she named her son Ichabod. The name Ichabod means "*The Glory of the Lord has departed.*"

What a sad commentary on a family that could have been divinely blessed of the Lord, but someone failed to see the need for refilling the reservoir of oil.

Stephen R. Covey – *“Ineffective people live day after day with unused potential. They experience synergy only in small peripheral ways in their lives. But creative experiences can be produced regularly, consistently, almost daily in peoples lives.”*

No oil – no light! No oil – no ministry!

II. NO (RE)FILLING - NO STAMINA

Matthew 25:1-13 (NKJV) *“Then the kingdom of heaven shall be likened to ten virgins who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. ² Now five of them were wise, and five were foolish. ³ Those who were foolish took their lamps and took no oil with them, ⁴ but the wise took oil in their vessels with their lamps.”*

To me, the most astonishing thing about this passage of Scripture is that the most significant day in the lives of these ten virgins is their wedding day, yet, five of them were ill prepared. They were not ready for the bridegroom for one reason; they had an insufficient amount of oil in their lamps to go the distance!

One of the most significant features of being continually full of the Holy Spirit is endurance in the face of adversity. The reason the five foolish virgins failed to go the distance is because the oil level in their lamps was not a priority.

The virgins who had an adequate supply of oil are referred to in Scripture as “*wise virgins.*” The five virgins who failed to bring an adequate supply of oil are referred to as “*foolish virgins*” and I want to point out the fact that the foolish virgins did not get married. They did not go the distance!

They were too focused on things other than the wedding. The failure to have enough oil is inexcusable. The failure of the foolish virgins was not immorality it was a failure to focus on the importance of the wedding. C.S. Lewis - “*If you read history you will find that the Christians*

who did most for the present world were precisely those who thought most of the next. It is since Christians have largely ceased to think of the other world that they have become so ineffective in this.”

The first century Church was full of people who went the distance in spite of the odds. Look at the perseverance of the twelve disciples:

- Andrew died on a cross
- Simon was crucified
- Bartholomew was flayed alive
- James the son of Zebedee was beheaded
- James the son of Alphaeus was beaten to death
- Thomas was run through with a lance
- Mathias was stoned and then beheaded
- Matthew was slain by the sword
- Peter was crucified upside down
- Thaddeus was shot to death with arrows
- Philip was hanged

- Only John made it through alive but he was boiled in oil and exiled to a small island in the middle of the Mediterranean Sea

Jesus is coming:

- Wise parents are making sure the family has plenty oil...
- Wise pastors are creating a sense of hunger among their parishioners...
- Wise saints are contending for the fullness of God...
- Wise churches are making room for the work of the Holy Spirit...

Constantly being refilled will insure the ability to go the distance.

III. (RE)FILLED – REWARD

Mark 16:19-20 (NKJV) *“So then, after the Lord had spoken to them, He was received up*

into heaven, and sat down at the right hand of God. ²⁰ And they went out and preached everywhere, the Lord working with them and confirming the word through the accompanying signs. Amen.”

Before Pentecost the Disciples of Jesus were a group of wishy-washy, rag-tag misfits, but after Pentecost they were a determined band of people who stayed full of the Spirit and went the distance. Though the winds of persecution were severe, they took the word quit out of their vocabulary and *“turned their world upside down!”*

Look at the results following this epic Pentecostal event in the Upper Room:

- 3,000 saved the first day... (Acts 2:37-38)
- God added to the church daily such as should be saved... (Acts 2:47)

- 2,000 are saved at Solomon's Porch... (Acts 3:1-4)
- The Samaritans become Christians... (Acts 8:1-12)
- Men and women were baptized following their conversion... (Acts 8:12-13)
- The Ethiopian eunuch is converted... (Acts 8:36-39)
- Saul (Paul) receives Christ... (Acts 9:18)
- The household of Cornelius becomes Christians... (Acts 10:43)
- The people of Antioch are converted... (Acts 11:19-21)
- Sergius Paulus becomes a Christian... (Acts 13:4-12)
- Many Jews and religious proselytes follow Paul and Barnabas at Antioch... (Acts 13:13-48)
- A great multitude of individuals follow Christ at Iconium... (Acts 14:1)

- An undetermined number of people make decisions for Christ at Lystra and Derbe... (Acts 14)
- The Philippian jailer and his family become followers of Christ... (Acts 16)
- Lydia comes to faith in Christ... (Acts 16)
- A great multitude of the Greeks and many of the leading women join themselves to the faith at Thessalonica... (Acts 17:1-‘
- 12)
- The conversion of the Athenians at Mars Hill... (Acts 17:16-34)
- Many Corinthian people are converted... (Acts 18:8)
- At Corinth Aquila and Pricilla follow Jesus... (Acts 18:24-28)
- The twelve disciples of John the Baptist are converted... (Acts 19:1-10)

Being filled is one thing, being refilled is absolutely essential. Tony Robbins - *“It’s not*

knowing what to do, it's doing what you know."

CONCLUSION:

Zig Ziglar – "People often say that motivation doesn't last. Well, neither does bathing, that's why we recommend it daily."

In these last days, the difference between success and failure will be the concentration of the oil of the Holy Spirit in the life of the believer.